there—on each occasion they were there together, alone—I said "We are police officers, we shall take you to the station for stealing a watch and chain last night"—we took them into custody—Coleman said "All right, I will go with you"—Cronin said nothing—I took them to Bow Street—they were placed with seven others; the prosecutor identified the three prisoners, and said, pointing to Coleman, "That is the man that stole my watch"—he pointed out no others—Coleman was wearing a cap then; on the night of the 18th he had on a black felt hat.

SIDNEY TREMLETT (*Policeman E* 350). On the evening of the 18th I went into the Two Spies, and I went in again on the 19th and took Thomas into custody.

NOT GUILTY

NEW COURT.—*Saturday, September 19th*, 1885.

Before Mr. Recorder.

843. FRANCES LEVICK (18) PLEADED GUILTY to unlawfully obtaining by false pretences two pairs of boots and two pair of shoes of Henry Bateman.—*Ten Days' Imprisonment.* And 844. HENRY CLEMENTS (61) to burglary in the dwelling-house of Henry Ewens, and stealing three spoons and other articles, after a conviction of felony at Clerkenwell in November, 1879.—*Nine Months' Hard Labour.*

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845. GEORGINA LOUISA RYAN, Stealing 1½ yards of ribbon, the property of William Whiteley.

MR. GRAIN *Prosecuted;* MESSRS EDWARD CLARKE, Q.C., *and* BESLEY *Defended.*

MARGARET WILLSFORD. I am employed by Mr. Whiteley—on 11th July a sale commenced in several departments—I was engaged in the ribbon department with a great many others—I know the prisoner as a casual customer in my department for about 18 months—on 11th July she came to my counter and took up a piece of ribbon value 2¾*d.*—each piece is ticketed with the length and the price—I think she gave me a shilling in payment—I wrapped it in paper—we always put the amount we receive on the bottom of the bill, which is in duplicate, and give it to a cash boy, who takes it to the cashier, and then brings the change back to me with the stamped bill, and we then give it to the customer—I did that with reference to Mrs. Ryan on that occasion—while the cash boy was going to the desk I noticed the prisoner rolling some pieces of ribbon very tight in her hand, and when the boy came back with the change she dropped them in the box from which she had taken them—I was serving a customer below when the cash boy came back, and when I saw him coming I went towards her, and she then dropped the ribbon—she had an open bag on her arm—in consequence of what I had seen I made a communication to Mr. Strickland, the shopwalker in my department.

Cross-examined by MR. CLARKE. I have been at Mr. Whiteley's about 4½ years—I might have known the prisoner for more than 18 months, but I did not take any notice of her—I have not become aware that she has been a regular customer of Mr. Whiteley's for years—I have heard since this case has been on that she has used the banking department of Whiteley's for the purpose of cashing cheques—I have not heard that her boxes were housed at Whiteley's for a considerable time, or that

their carts called regularly on her with bread—these sales are very busy affairs—there are two regular days a week for selling remnants—the 11th or 22nd was not one of those days—we always have the goods exposed on the counter—the 11th was a day of great pressure of business—we very often get such crowds that there is a difficulty in dealing with them—the counter at which I was stationed is a very long one, not quite as long as this Court—there are 10 other assistants there besides me—this is exclusively a ribbon counter, which was covered with boxes with remnants in them—the people who come to buy these remnants take them up and look at them and put them down again—there are two other counters in this shop, one at the top and one at the bottom—mine is in the centre—the top of the shop is at the other end from the door—there are five at that counter and four at the bottom one—we always keep the same position at the counter—to get to the antimacassar department from the ribbon department you would have to go through two shops, it is further in the building, and to get to the banking department you would have to go through five shops—ladies loiter about in the shops a great deal at the time of these sales looking at different things—I saw the prisoner two or three times after that during the day on which she was charged with stealing, going from one shop to the other—I have seen her served in the ribbon department since the 11th by other assistants—I do not remember saying at the police-court "I have seen the prisoner twice since the 11th; she then purchased from other assistants at the same counter."

EMILY PAINE. I am assistant to Mr. Whiteley—I have known the prisoner 18 months as a customer there—on 22nd July she came to my counter and selected some ribbon value 1¾*d.*—I made out a bill—she gave me two pennies, which I took and the bill to the desk, and brought it back with a farthing—on my way back to the counter Mr. Strickland spoke to me—I then handed the prisoner the ribbon wrapped in paper, enclosing the bill, and the farthing—she had then a bag on her arm—when I served her she took the money from it, and left it open—after I gave her the parcel she went straight out at the door.

Cross-examined. This was a very busy day—I stood next to Miss Willsford at the counter; she was on my left—I can't say whether she was close to me when I served the prisoner; there was a line of assistants on one side of the counter, and a line of customers waiting to be served on the other side—I don't remember seeing the prisoner going through the ribbon department earlier that day—I saw her at the counter a very long time, not waiting to be served, but looking into all the boxes as she went along—I have noticed that she is very short-sighted, and obliged to look very closely at things—she had a parcel under her arm; I had seen her before that morning without the parcel—I had to go about 20 yards to the desk to pay the money—1*s.* 11½*d.* is a good price for a remnant—I find customers, as a rule, wait for their bills—if a person purchased a piece of ribbon marked 6*d.*, and handed over the sixpence and did not wait for the bill, it would be destroyed—when I was serving the prisoner Mr. Strickland was two or three yards off.

Re-examined. We always make out two bills, whether the customer takes it or not; it must be passed through the desk.

ALFRED STRICKLAND. I am shopwalker to Mr. Whiteley, in the ribbon department—a sale was on on the 11th, which continued up to and

included the 22nd—I recollect Miss Willsford speaking to me on the 11th—the prisoner was in the shop, and within my view; I had seen her twice before that—in consequence of what she told me I fixed my attention upon the prisoner—on 22nd July I saw her again in the ribbon department; Miss Paine was in the act of serving her—I was standing from two to three yards from her—I saw Miss Paine go from the counter towards the receiving desk; she spoke to me on the way, and I saw the prisoner put a piece of ribbon into her bag, which was open, and resting on the boxes on the counter—it bore our marks—I saw Miss Paine give her the change and the parcel, which she put in her bag, closed it, and walked towards the door down the shop—I followed her, and let her precede me into the street, and stopped her opposite the second shop from No. 51—I touched her lightly on the shoulder and asked her if she would allow me to see what was in her bag—she did not appear to hear me, or she was confused—I said again "I want to see what you have in your bag"—she said "I don't know what you mean"—I said "Come inside, I will tell you"—she followed me into No. 47, and placed her bag on a glass case; it was open, and I found in it the ribbon which I saw her put in—I asked her to come with me to the office—she followed me there, and I there reported the matter—she was asked to account for the possession of the ribbon—she made no reply to the first question—it was repeated, and she then said "I bought it"—she was then asked to produce the bill—she made a search in her bag, and then said she supposed she had lost it—I asked her if she would point out the assistant who served her—she said she could not do that, and offered to pay for it—I then sent for a police-officer.

Cross-examined. I have been at Whiteley's four months—Mr. Whiteley, I believe, is in Germany—this conversation took place in the presence of Mr. Arthur, manager of the counting-house—she has cashed cheques there, but I do not know if she cashed one that morning—I saw her with a parcel of antimacassars under her arm, which she had bought at Whiteley's that day, but I didn't notice it when she stood at the counter—I did not see her pick up the piece of black ribbon, but I saw her hand come from the open box in which the ribbons were, and on which her bag was standing, the boxes on the counter—it was between 12 and 12.30 in the day—I did not notice that she was deaf—she said she had bought the ribbon.

BENJAMIN BENNETT (*Detective Sergeant X*). I was called to Mr. Whiteley's on the 22nd, and the prisoner was given in my custody—she said she was willing to pay for the ribbon—I examined her bag at the station—I found upon her 6*l*. 10*s*. 8*d*. in money and some other articles.

Cross-examined. I have heard that Whiteley's men called regularly at her house.

JOHN WALTER JUPE. I am dissecting clerk at Whiteley's, I analyse the bills—I produce all the bills for all sales from the two desks in the ribbon department—there is no bill for the sale of a piece of ribbon at 1*s*. 11½*d*. on 22nd July.

Cross-examined. Miss Paine would pay into desk 53—the 505 on this bill is the number of the assistant—I cannot tell you the number of the bills in each of these bundles—I do not think the assistants sometimes put the goods of different customers on the same bill.

The prisoner received an excellent character. NOT GUILTY.

The prisoner, in defence, said he was going home when the constable followed on his heels. Some young fellows he knew wanted to take him home. The policeman punched him in the back and knocked him on the ground; he struggled for breath, and if he kicked the policeman it was not done wilfully, but accidentally, in the struggle to get away. Two or three gentlemen complained, and when the sergeant came up a gentleman said he would report him if he did not put a stop to it; the policeman having kicked him in the jaw and knocked him about very much till and when he got in the dock.

GUILTY**†—*Three Years' Penal Servitude.*

The COMMON SERGEANT *concurred in the commendation by the Grand Jury of the policeman's courage, and regretted the law did not empower him to direct a reward.*

NEW COURT.—*Wednesday, May 22nd*, 1895.

Before Mr. Recorder.

454. HANNAH WILSON (40) and ANN HANSTEAD (40), Stealing eighty-six yards of silk, the property of Charles De Selincourt.

MR. SIMMONS *Prosecuted, and* MR. PURCELL *Defended.*

SIDNEY GROVER. I am warehouseman to De Selincourt and Son, of 16 and 18, Cannon Street—on May 3rd the prisoners came in together, one followed the other closely through the folding doors—Wilson said she wanted to buy a job *line*—Hanstead was near her—I recognised Wilson, and my suspicions were aroused—I showed them some silk, and they wanted some patterns cut off—I turned round to get another piece of silk and heard the noise of silk being pulled along, I turned round and Wilson was leaning like this between me and Hanstead—there is a support in the middle of the counter, but it is open on both sides, and the silk could be drawn from under it—the noise stopped, and when I looked away I heard it again under the counter—I went up to them and said, "Have you another *line?*" Wilson said, "We will buy the other *line* somewhere else"—they got very near the door, and I could see the shape of a piece of silk under Hanstead's skirt—it was rolled up like this, paper and all—I pushed by Wilson, and caught hold of Hanstead and said, "You cannot go, you have a piece of silk"—she tried to push me away and kicked it from under her skirt; it dropped, and she kicked it away—this is it—I know that it was under the counter that afternoon—I picked it up fifteen or twenty yards from there—there are eighty-six yards, value £4 6s.

Cross-examined. No one was serving or inside the warehouse but me—there were no other customers—I heard the prisoners say that they did not know one another—I say they were together, because one followed the other in immediately—they told the prosecutor they did not know one another—from the very first moment I was pretty confident they were trying to rob me—my mind has been trained by my experience in shop-lifting—a great number of these rolls of silk were placed under the counter—I placed about four rolls of silk on the table; there were none there before I began to serve them—Hanstead said that the roll of silk stuck to her dress—I tried to keep it there—Wilson said she was a respectable woman, of Hackney.

Re-examined. The piece of silk I found at her feet was not one of the pieces I put on the counter—it was not a job *line*—they did not deny before the Magistrate that they knew each other—what they said was, "*We* will get the job *line* elsewhere."

By the COURT. Hanstead's skirt was made with a slit down to the knees—the noise I heard was under the counter where the silk was—it was rolled up, and if it was pulled slowly it would make a noise like this (*Pulling it along.*)—some silk had been stolen on the Wednesday before—Wilson was in the shop that day, and I was therefore suspicious.

EDWARD SHUTTLE (666 *City*). I was sent for to Messrs. De Selincourt's, and on opening the door I saw Mr. Grover and the prisoners just inside the swing-doors, and this piece of silk lying on the ground at Hanstead's feet, which Grover said she had taken from under the counter and placed under her dress—Hanstead said, "I have not taken it; it could not have been me; I came in separate from her"—Wilson said that she did not know Hanstead, having come into the warehouse separately—Hanstead said that she came in to buy a job *line*, and met Wilson in the shop—both their dresses were made similar.

Cross-examined. The dresses were shown to the female searcher—she is not here—when the prisoners were charged with stealing the silk they made no reply—it would not be correct to say Wilson said, "I don't know anything about it;" Hanstead said, "I did not drop it."

GUILTY.—*They then both* PLEADED GUILTY *to a previous conviction of a like offence in the names of Ward and Sadler at this Court on June 27th, 1887.—Three Years' Penal Servitude, having still a portion of their former sentence to serve.*

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455. CHARLES HAND (21), Burglary in the dwelling-house of William Barber, with intent to steal.

MR. WILLES *Prosecuted.*

WILLIAM BARBER. I keep the Freemasons' Arms, Bryant Street, Bethnal Green—on Sunday night, April 21st, I closed my house—I heard a noise at the window about 12.45, got out of bed, went to my bedroom door, and saw the prisoner outside—I knew him—I walked him into my room and locked the door—I afterwards took him downstairs, called a constable and charged him—he had this fish-knife in his hand (*Produced*).

HENRY HATCHMAN (237 *H*). On April 22nd, about two a.m., Mr. Barber came to me; I went to his house, and saw the prisoner in the bar—I left him in charge of another officer—he had no boots on—the landing window had been forced open, and an iron bar removed—I found a pair of boots on the roof—the prisoner said nothing.

GUILTY.—*He received a good character, and the prosecutor recommended him to mercy.—Discharged on his own recognisances.*

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456. RICHARD CHARLES BEALL, Stealing a coat and waistcoat; *Second Count*, stealing a suit of clothes; *Third Count*, another suit of clothes, of Charles Naylor, his master.

MR. BLACKWELL *Prosecuted.*

CHARLES NAYLOR. I am a clothier, of 115, Petting Road, Bow—the prisoner was in my service five months—he had to go for orders for suits of clothes among the men in the *'bus* yard, and when